DEGREES OF COMPARISON

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There are three degrees of comparison:

*Positive degree :

as … as/as not as…..as

the same … (noun) as…

*Comparative degree :

…..er/more……than

*Superlative degree :

the….est / most ……

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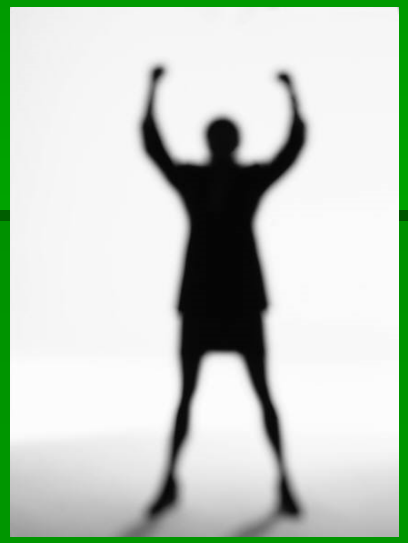
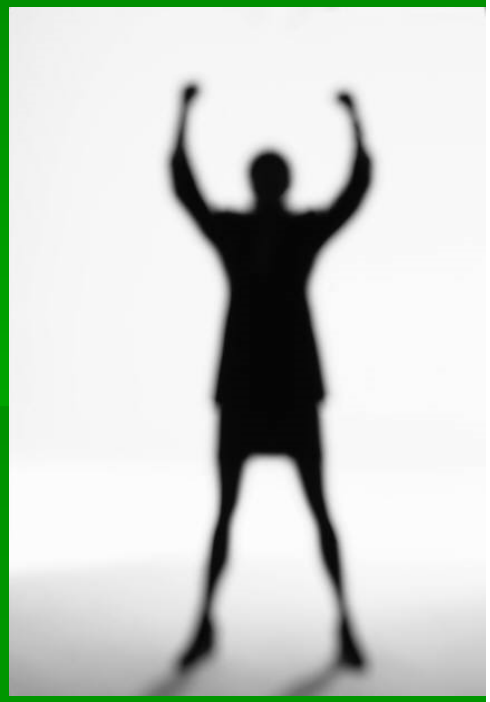
Look at the picture!

- tall /short
- Mr. A, B & C





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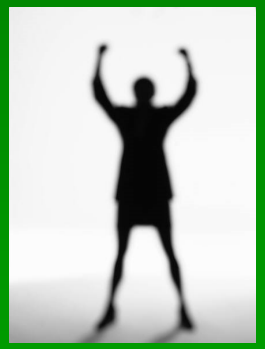
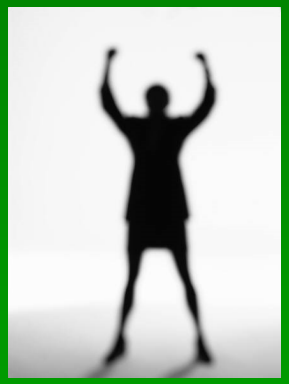
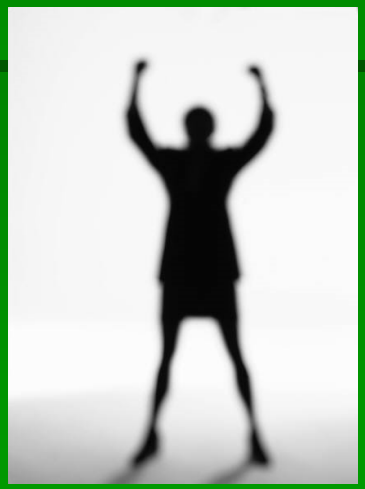
We can make some sentences :



A



B



C

- Mr. A is shorter than Mr. B.
- Mr. B is shorter than Mr. C.
- Mr. C is taller than Mr. B.
- Mr. C is the tallest man of all.
- Mr. A is the shortest man of all.

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Some common rules

in forming the comparative & superlative degrees of comparison:

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1. for one syllable word

- Add –er for the comparative degree & add – est for the superlative degree.

e.g :	tall	taller	tallest
	sweet	sweeter	sweetest

- Adjective end in –e, just add –r and –st.

e.g :	large	larger	largest
	late	later	latest

- If the adjectives end in a vowel & a consonant, double the consonant before adding –er and –est.

e.g :	fat	fatter	fattest
	thin	thinner	thinnest

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2. For two syllables words

- If the adjectives end in –y, change –y into –i, then add –*er* for comparative & add –*est* for superlative

  e.g : busy busier busiest

- For most adjective & adverbs, precede "more" for comparative & "most" for superlative.

  e.g : famous more famous most famous

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Special adjectives

Some two syllable adjectives have two possible forms of comparisons.

common	commoner/more common	commonest /most common
likely	likelier / more likely	likeliest / most likely
pleasant	pleasanter/more pleasant	pleasantest/most pleasant
polite	politer / more polite	politest / most polite
simple	simpler / more simple	simplest / most simple
stupid	stupider / more stupid	stupidest / most stupid
subtle	subtler / more subtle	subtlest / most subtle
sure	surer / more sure	surest / most sure

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3. Notice

- For the adverbs end in –*ly* either of two or more syllable precede *more* for the comparative & *most* for superlative.

  e.g :slowly more slowly most slowly

IT IS AN EXEPTION FOR THE ADV. EARLY. It uses suffix –er & -est.

early earlier earliest

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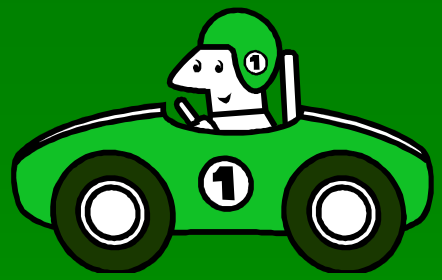
4. Notice



- For more than two syllables words, just precede *more* for comparative & *most* for superlative.

e.g: expensive	more expensive
	most expensive
difficult	more difficult
	most difficult

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5. Some irregular forms

Positive	*Comparative*	*Superlative*
bad/ill	worse	worst
good/well	better	best
little	less	least
many/much	more	most
late	later	latest
	latter	last
far (distance)	farther	farthest
far (time)	further	furthest
old (family member)	elder	eldest
old (age)	older	oldest

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Make Comparisons based on the following data!

- 1. Each student arrives at school at different time.

  a. Nazil arrives at 6 a.m.

  b. Suci arrives at 6.10 a.m.

  c. Rahayu arrives at 6.30 a.m.

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- There are three books which have different prices.

  a. a mathematic book is Rp. 45.000,-

  b. an English book is Rp. 50.000,-

  c. a history book is 60.000,-

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- Three women have different ages.

  a. Ms. Nining is 35 years old.

  b. Mrs. Ranti is 31 years old.

  c. Mrs. Hartanti is 37 years old.

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- Each student has different English grades.

  a. Anam got 7

  b. Taufik got 6

  c. Wachit got 8

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- There are girls who have different heights.

  a. Fizka is 160 cm tall.

  b. Yunani is 150 cm tall.

  c. Desy is 170 cm tall.

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